

: What is it? [Runs out a few paces and hears Shere Khan muttering and mumbling as he tumbles about in the scrub.] The fool has had no more sense than to jump at a woodcutter's campfire, and has burned his feet. [With a grunt]. Tabaqui is with him.

: Something is coming uphill. [Twitching one ear] Get ready!

: The bushes rustled a little in the forest and Father Wolf dropped with his haunches under him, ready for his leap. Then, if you had been watching, you would have seen the most wonderful thing in the world – the wolf checked in mid-spring.

He made his bound before he saw what it was he was jumping at, and then tried to stop himself. The result was that he shot up straight into the air for four or five feet, landing almost where he left ground.

: Man! (Snaps) A Man's cub. Look!

: Directly in front of him, holding on by a low branch, stood a naked baby who could just walk – as soft and as dimpled a little atom as ever came to a wolf's cave at night. He looked up into Father Wolf's face and laughed.

: Is that a Man's cub? I have never seen one. Bring it here.

: A wolf accustomed to moving his own cubs can if necessary, eat an egg without breaking it, and though Father Wolf's jaws closed right on the child's back not a tooth even scratched the skin as he laid it down among the cubs.

6th_English_Term_III_116-132.indd 120 05-08-2020 14:53:38